

Annual IT Systems Audit Report — Fiscal Year 2024

Executive Summary

This report presents the findings of the annual IT systems audit conducted across all business units of Apex Financial Services. The audit covered infrastructure security, data management practices, software licensing compliance, and disaster recovery preparedness across 14 regional offices.

1. Infrastructure Assessment

Network infrastructure across all sites was assessed against ISO 27001 standards. Findings indicate that 87 percent of endpoints are running current firmware versions. Three legacy servers identified in the Manchester office require immediate patching due to known vulnerabilities in their operating system versions. Cloud migration progress stands at 64 percent of planned workloads.

2. Access Control Review

User access privileges were reviewed across all internal systems. A total of 43 dormant accounts were identified and subsequently deactivated. Privileged access management controls were found to be compliant in 11 of 14 offices. Multi-factor authentication has been successfully rolled out to 94 percent of all active user accounts across the entire organisation.

3. Data Management Findings

Database audit logs indicate 99.7 percent uptime across primary database clusters. Backup verification tests were completed successfully for all critical systems. Three instances of unencrypted data transfer were flagged in the Birmingham office and have been escalated to the regional IT manager for remediation within a 30-day resolution window as required.

4. Recommendations

Priority recommendations include immediate patching of legacy servers, completion of MFA rollout to remaining 6 percent of users, implementation of automated dormant account detection, and a full review of third-party vendor access privileges. A follow-up audit is scheduled for Q2 2025 to verify remediation of all critical and high-severity findings identified.